

Start with how you read world politics

The Foundation gives the first read. Modules and AI Governance test it in harder policy settings. Profile keeps the saved results together.

Start the IR Foundation

Resume saved draft

Advanced mode · 45 questions answered on this device.

This is an interpretive tool, not a diagnostic. It makes theoretical priors visible without treating them as a final verdict.

HOW TO USE IT

Start with the Foundation. Add issue layers only when they help. Return to Profile for the accumulated read.

- 1 Foundation**
Build the shared IR baseline: power, institutions, domestic politics, norms, political economy, restraint, and order.
- 2 Modules**
Test that baseline in Security and Technology without replacing the Foundation result.
- 3 AI Governance**
Take the AI layer on its own, or compare it with your IR baseline when that helps.
- 4 Profile**
Return to the place where the Foundation, modules, and any AI result sit together.

Atlas, the field guide, and methods pages give

context around the inventory; they are not separate places to begin.

AFTER THE FOUNDATION

Add another layer only when it clarifies the baseline

These are the live continuation points in the current beta. Each keeps the Foundation in view.

STEP 2

Modules: Security and Technology

Use the live IR modules to see whether your baseline holds, hardens, or splits in concrete cases.

Open modules

Two live focus-area overlays are available now.

STEP 3

AI Governance Compass

Read your instincts on frontier AI governance. It stands on its own, but it is sharper beside the IR baseline.

Open AI Governance

A related layer in the same worldview product.

Profile

Use Profile as the home for saved results: the Foundation, completed modules, and any AI result on this device.

Open Profile

Most useful after at least one result has been saved.

CONTEXT SURFACES

Use these once you want a wider frame

Atlas, the field guide, and methods pages help you read the map after the baseline is in place.

Atlas

Browse recurring profile patterns without treating them as fixed identities.

Field guide

Read the modeled traditions, coverage gaps, and issue comparisons behind the inventory.

Methods

Read the scope, guardrails, and limits behind the project.

The IR Worldview Inventory is an editorial interactive built by JinHua Yip for readers who want a clearer account of the assumptions behind their foreign-policy instincts.

The product is still in beta. This version prioritizes trust, clarity, and legibility before breadth.

Use the Foundation as the baseline. Branch into modules, AI Governance, Atlas, or Profile when they add useful depth or comparison.

FOUNDATION RESULT

A political-economy attuned, domestic-politics aware foundation profile

LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

In live debates, this profile tends to attend first to rule credibility, monitoring, and whether institutions can actually change incentives. Strategically, it keeps restraint and competition live at the same time rather than settling the question in advance. Normatively, it treats order and justice as a live tradeoff rather than an already solved hierarchy.

RESULT SIGNATURE

A compact read of the strongest dimension pulls and modifiers shaping this Foundation result.

Markets and dependence 5.8 / 7



Domestic politics 5.7 / 7



Security rivalry 5.3 / 7



FAMILY
Liberal Institutional

STRATEGY
Hedger

NORMS
Conditional Solidarist

NEAREST OVERLAP
Critical Political
Economist

Main signals

Start here: these are the pulls doing the most work in this Foundation result.

STRONGEST SIGNAL

Political economy is central

You think world politics cannot be understood without examining capitalism, production structures, finance, and the distribution of economic dependence.

SECOND SIGNAL

Domestic politics as a real driver

You emphasize how regime type, coalitions, and bureaucratic capacity shape what states actually do in foreign policy.

THIRD SIGNAL

Rivalry as a persistent constraint

You treat uncertainty about rivals' intentions as a structural feature of international politics, not a problem reassurance can solve.

How settled this result is

You prefer restraint as a strategy but take security competition seriously. Knowing when to hold back and when a window demands action is the hardest strategic call. Your profile leaves that question open.

Trust and coverage

This is the closest fit among the traditions currently modeled in the inventory, not a final or exhaustive identity. Treat it as one atlas marker in the wider mosaic. Methods explains the limits →

Add a focus-area module

View your Profile

Dimension profile

These are model positions, not population percentiles.

Security rivalry

5.3 / 7



You treat uncertainty about rivals' intentions as a durable constraint, not a solvable problem.

Institutions and rules

4.8 / 7



You think institutions can matter, but only when credible and not obviously captured.

Domestic politics

5.7 / 7



You emphasize how regime type, coalitions, and bureaucratic capacity shape foreign policy.

Identity and legitimacy

5.0 / 7



You think the meaning of threats and alliances depends partly on identities and shared expectations.

Markets and dependence

5.8 / 7



You think world politics cannot be understood without examining capitalism, finance, and dependence.

Restraint and advantage

5 / 7



You think the safest grand strategy is to avoid overextension and resist permanent primacy.

Order and justice

4.7 / 7



You hold the order-justice tradeoff open. Neither side dominates in your view.

Atlas

Atlas gives plain-English names to patterns that show up repeatedly in the current model. It is a browsing aid, not a live map of users.

NEAREST ATLAS PATTERN

Coalition Pragmatist

MOSTLY LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Also overlaps with Strategic Realist and Social Constructivist.

This pattern prefers workable coordination and durable partner alignment over either rigid bloc discipline or go-it-alone autonomy.

Competition		Medium
Institutions		High
Legitimacy		Medium
Political economy		Medium
Restraint		High

What usually drives it

- Partners must be able to carry the policy
- Institutions help when they work
- Pressure is weighed against coalition durability

Under pressure: Security usually turns this pattern toward alliance endurance, while Technology usually turns it toward coordinated controls and shared standards.

Nearby patterns

Add a focus-area overlay

Your Foundation result is still the baseline. These modules show where concrete issue cases reinforce it, complicate it, or pull against it.

FOCUS-AREA MODULE

Security, Strategy, and Statecraft

Most cases start from familiar security debates about deterrence, alliances, escalation, and legitimacy. A smaller set of pressure tests shifts to exposed partners, rival powers, and nonaligned states when the vantage point changes the strategic read.

Standard: 8 to 10 minutes · Advanced: 14 to 18 minutes

FOCUS-AREA MODULE

Technology, AI, and Geoeconomics

Most cases start from familiar debates about chokepoints, industrial policy, AI governance, and strategic dependence. A smaller set of pressure tests shifts to sanctioned, middle-power, and nonaligned perspectives when the vantage point changes the policy read.

Standard: 8 to 10 minutes · Advanced: 14 to 18 minutes

Interpretation and comparison

Open these if you want the longer read, the nearest overlap, and the questions that could pressure-test this result.

Closest traditions and why this shorthand fits

Longer interpretation, issue bridges, and pressure-test questions

Where to go next

These readings help you deepen this result, test it against its nearest rival, and keep exploring across the project.

START HERE

Read the modeled tradition page first, then begin with one anchor text before you widen the frame.

USE THE PRODUCT

Read Liberal Institutionalism — See the tradition guide, issue readings, and critique shelf in one place.

After Hegemony

Robert Keohane

The core argument for why international institutions can sustain cooperation even without a dominant enforcer.

GO DEEPER

USE THE PRODUCT

Stay with the nearest fit long enough to see its internal variation, methods, and adjacent debates.

Browse references — Use the wider bibliography when you want more than the result-page shelf.

Read methods — See the model limits, terminology choices, and why the labels stay interpretive.

Designing Social Inquiry

King, Keohane & Verba

Not IR theory directly, but the methodological backbone of much liberal IR scholarship.

The Great Transformation

Karl Polanyi

A historical argument for how markets and governance co-evolve — relevant to why domestic filters and transnational actors matter.

CHALLENGE YOUR VIEW

Read the nearest runner-up and test the profile in harder issue settings rather than treating the top label as closed.

USE THE PRODUCT

Read Critical Political Economist — Read the closest alternative tradition and compare its issue logic directly.

Add a focus-area overlay — Pressure-test the baseline in Security or Technology before treating it as settled.

States and Markets

Susan Strange

The argument that financial structures create power independent of formal authority — still the sharpest introduction to structural power.

Global Political Economy

Robert Gilpin

A readable overview of the three main approaches — realist, liberal, and Marxist — to international economic order.

Glossary

Short definitions for the recurring terms on this page.

[Read glossary](#)

About this classification

Structured thought exercise, not a validated scientific diagnostic. Tradition labels are shorthand for a multidimensional profile, and case-based readings stay separate from the foundation result. Scores are comparative within this model, not population percentiles. [Full methods note](#) →

[View your Profile](#) →

[Share feedback on this inventory](#) →

Saved to this device

FOCUS-AREA MODULE

Security, Strategy, and Statecraft

A focused read on deterrence, alliances, escalation, and the legitimacy of force

Most cases start from familiar security debates about deterrence, alliances, escalation, and legitimacy. A smaller set of pressure tests shifts to exposed partners, rival powers, and nonaligned states when the vantage point changes the strategic read.

FOUNDATION LINKAGE

How this fits with your Foundation

CURRENT FOUNDATION BASELINE

Liberal Institutionalism on this device
Hedger · Conditional Solidarist

THIS MODULE PRESSURE-TESTS

- Deterrence and escalation
- Alliances and autonomy
- Order, legitimacy, and protection

WHAT CAN CHANGE HERE

This result does not replace the Foundation. It shows how the baseline behaves in one issue area.

MODE

Standard gives you 9 questions and a cleaner first pass. Advanced expands that to 15, with 6 extra cases and a small set of actor-lens pressure tests. In both modes, you can add a backup choice when a second answer genuinely fits.



Standard

9 questions · 8 to 10 minutes



Advanced

15 questions · 14 to 18 minutes

IN-FLOW SHORTHAND

Security Pressure

15 scored items in this mode.

WHAT IT MEASURES

- pressure versus crisis-limiting instincts
- alliance-centered versus autonomy-sensitive coalition instincts
- order-first versus protection-sensitive views of force and legitimacy
- how explanation cards differ from decision cards when the case sharpens

WHAT IT DOES NOT CLAIM

- a fixed security identity that overrides the Foundation baseline
- a full theory of grand strategy across every theater
- role-play or nationality-adjusted answers

Visible lanes

Each case sits inside one lane so the module reads like a structured set of cases, not one large basket of debates.

DETERRENCE AND ESCALATION

How you handle probing, coercion, and crisis ceilings.

0 of 5

0%

ALLIANCES AND AUTONOMY

How exposed partners, coalition durability, and hedging space should be read.

0 of 5

0%

ORDER, LEGITIMACY, AND PROTECTION

How you weigh order, legal authority, civilian protection, and bounded action.

0 of 5

0%

Perspective coverage across the full set of cases

Most cases start from familiar debates in this issue area. A smaller set of actor-lens pressure tests then asks how the same problem looks from

exposed partners, rival powers, and nonaligned or development-focused governments.

This keeps the baseline legible without pretending other actors think the same way.

Alliance manager / default coalition-facing logic · Counterparty or rival-power logic · Exposed ally or vulnerable smaller state · Middle-power or nonaligned hedging logic · Developmental / dependency / capacity-constrained actor · Legality / protection / authority logic

How to answer these cases

Read the scene first, then the tradeoff.

- On **Explanation** cards, choose the logic that best explains the case.
- On **Decision** cards, choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.
- On **Actor lens** cards, choose the logic that would look strongest from that actor's own strategic position.

Answer from your own analytic judgment, not from what sounds most moderate or most publicly defensible. If another option also fits, add it as your backup choice.

Foundation comparison is on

This module can compare back to your Foundation result, but it stays a focused issue read rather than replacing the baseline.

0 of 15 answered

0%

SECURITY PRESSURE · LANE

Deterrence and escalation

How you handle probing, coercion, and crisis ceilings.

0 of 5 answered in this lane

0%

DETERRENCE AND ESCALATION · DECISION · 1 OF 5

Quarantine pressure around Taiwan

SCENE

Day three of a quarantine around Taiwan. Insurers are pulling back, container traffic is slowing, and no shots have been fired. In Beijing, leaders are deciding what should govern the next move while they still claim the inspections are lawful and limited.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Too little pressure can make the move look hollow. Too much pressure can turn coercion below war into a direct clash before Beijing knows how far outside powers will go.

QUESTION

What should matter most first?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Make the line unmistakable

The first job is to show that pressure below invasion can still change behavior before outside coalitions settle.

2

Build a long squeeze

The stronger move is to wear down traffic, insurers, and political stamina over time rather than force one dramatic showdown.

3

Keep regional states divided

Pressure works best if nearby states are not pushed into a fast, hard anti-China alignment.

4

Keep the pressure framed as law and politics

Economic and diplomatic pressure matters most if the operation still looks limited enough to avoid a wider military jump.

IR Worldview Inventory

ISSUE MODULE

Security & Strategy Questionnaire

QUESTIONS

Exit to modules

DETERRENCE AND ESCALATION · EXPLANATION · 2 OF 5

Gray-zone sabotage

SCENE

After three weeks of cable cuts, rail disruptions, and port outages across two allied states, intelligence services privately assess a rival state's hand as likely but not courtroom-grade. An alliance ministerial must decide what the campaign is really testing before it makes the next public statement.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

If attribution stays contested, allies can agree the pattern is hostile while still disagreeing about whether it calls for punishment, resilience, or restraint.

QUESTION

What is the most persuasive reading of what the rival is testing?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1

Test response thresholds

The incidents are mainly testing whether ambiguity lets the rival impose costs without triggering a firm threshold response.

2

Test coalition fracture points

The target is the political gap between partners with different thresholds for acting on incomplete evidence.

3

Map resilience gaps

The rival is exploiting repair, redundancy, and recovery weaknesses more than it is trying to trigger one dramatic showdown.

4

Create an attribution trap

The point is to provoke an overreaction on partial evidence and turn allied caution into a strategic restraint on themselves.

DETERRENCE AND ESCALATION · DECISION · 3 OF 5

Retaliation under sanctions pressure

SCENE

After a covert strike on a sensitive site and a wave of proxy attacks across the region, Tehran is deciding how to respond. Some officials want a visible strike to restore deterrence. Others argue that survival under sanctions matters more than one dramatic answer.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

A restrained response can invite more pressure. A direct response can widen the war under conditions Iran may not control.

QUESTION

What should matter most in the response?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Restore deterrence visibly

If the answer looks weak, outside strikes and covert pressure may start to look low-cost.

2

Work through deniable channels

The stronger path is to use partners, proxies, and indirect pressure where the balance is less exposed.

3

Keep the ceiling low

The deeper danger is being pulled into a broader war that Iran cannot bound on favorable terms.

4

Raise the political cost through diplomacy

Iran gains more by widening the diplomatic and regional cost of further strikes than by chasing immediate military drama.

DETERRENCE AND ESCALATION · EXPLANATION · 4 OF 5

Nuclear threshold and preventive force

SCENE

At a regional crisis review, inspectors report Iran may be closer to being able to cross the nuclear threshold than six months ago, but intent and weaponization timelines remain disputed. Israel, Gulf partners, and Western governments are arguing over whether this is mainly a bargaining problem, a long-run containment problem, an allied coordination problem, or a question about what kind of action could still be defended publicly and legally.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The more it feels as if Iran could reach the nuclear threshold soon, the easier it is for the debate to slide from pressure and bargaining into preventive-war logic.

QUESTION

What is the strongest reading of what this case is mainly about?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

- 1

Leverage is evaporating

The real issue is that once it starts to feel normal that Iran could reach the nuclear threshold soon, diplomacy loses pressure faster than it can recover it.
- 2

Containment is safer

The key problem is how to avoid turning a bad nuclear position into an even wider war through premature force.
- 3

Coalition management comes first

The central question is whether partners can sustain a credible common line long enough for pressure to mean anything.
- 4

Legitimacy sets the ceiling

What matters most is whether any harder move can still be defended as bounded and politically sustainable.

Coercion below blockade

SCENE

In a Taiwan crisis, Beijing wants to raise pressure without taking the full legal and military leap of open blockade or invasion. Officials debate whether the main aim is to normalize a new baseline, split outside coalitions, probe response thresholds, or keep the crisis below a costlier war line.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

More than one purpose can be real at once, but the main diagnosis changes how the whole move is read.

QUESTION

What is the strongest reading of why Beijing would prefer coercion below outright blockade?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1

Normalize a new baseline

The core aim is to make extraordinary interference look routine enough that others slowly adapt to it.

2

Split the outside coalition

Pressure below war works best if allies and regional states keep disagreeing about when coercion becomes intolerable.

3

Probe response thresholds

The main aim is to learn what kinds of coercion outsiders will absorb before they act decisively.

4

Keep the military ceiling low

The stronger logic is to coerce while still staying below the costs of open war.

SECURITY PRESSURE · LANE

Alliances and autonomy

How exposed partners, coalition durability, and hedging space should be read.

0 of 5 answered in this lane

0%

ALLIANCES AND AUTONOMY · DECISION · 1 OF 5

Eastern-flank reassurance

SCENE

After repeated sabotage scares and airspace incidents, a NATO state on the eastern flank asks for a more permanent allied presence. Some partners favor a visible tripwire; others want a posture built around reinforcement, mobility, and local denial.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

A signal that reassures exposed allies may also look like routine escalation if it becomes too rigid or too symbolic.

QUESTION

What should matter most in the posture decision?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1 **Make the promise visible**

A forward presence matters first because exposed allies need proof that any attack instantly widens the coalition.

2 **Build reinforcement depth**

Deterrence is strongest when the posture can be reinforced quickly and sustained politically, not just displayed.

3 **Prioritize local denial**

Frontline states need their own mobilization, civil defense, and denial capacity more than they need a symbolic outside footprint.

4 **Pair reassurance with limits**

Reassurance should stay tied to explicit ceilings so that every incident does not become a crisis of posture.

ALLIANCES AND AUTONOMY · DECISION · 2 OF 5

Outside help without formal alignment

SCENE

A Southeast Asian state faces repeated maritime pressure from a much larger power. It wants help, but not formal bloc alignment that would narrow its diplomatic room or turn every dispute into a choice between opposing blocs.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Outside backing can strengthen the smaller state, but the wrong form of backing can also reduce the autonomy it is trying to preserve.

QUESTION

What should matter most when outside states offer support?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1 **Use hard external backing**

Without stronger outside balancing, legal claims and coast guards will not offset material asymmetry for long.

2 **Protect hedging room**

Smaller states often survive by diversifying ties and avoiding security arrangements that narrow their diplomatic options too early.

3 **Multilateralize pressure**

The more durable answer is to widen the political cost of coercion through law, regional diplomacy, and shared monitoring.

4 **Build local resilience**

What matters first is resilient local capacity: surveillance, denial tools, and shock absorption at home.

ALLIANCES AND AUTONOMY · ACTOR LENS · 3 OF 5

Border pressure when a state wants help but not full alignment

SCENE

A large democracy faces repeated Chinese pressure along a disputed border. It wants weapons, intelligence help, and investment from the United States and other major powers, but it does not want one alignment decision to dictate every trade and diplomatic choice. Its cabinet is deciding how to hold that line before outside partners demand a cleaner break.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

From Washington or other allied capitals, closer alignment can look like the obvious answer. From inside this cabinet, preserving bargaining room may still look like part of security itself.

QUESTION

From this government's side, which logic looks strongest?

Optional context

Choose the logic that would look strongest from that actor's own strategic position, not the policy you personally prefer.

1

Prepare for a forced choice

If rivalry keeps sharpening, the state may need to bank credibility with Washington before the room to hedge closes.

2

Separate security from the rest

The state can deepen security ties where needed without turning trade, finance, and diplomacy into one bloc decision.

3

Treat autonomy as security

From this position, bargaining room is part of national security, not a refusal to take threats seriously.

4

Join coalitions case by case

The most durable strategy is to join coalitions on specific problems without accepting whole-of-state alignment.

Extended deterrence and nuclear hedging

SCENE

An exposed ally begins debating an independent nuclear option because it no longer fully trusts extended deterrence. Some officials want unmistakable reassurance; others think the moment calls for a broader political framework that lowers demand for new arsenals.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Reassurance, nonproliferation, and autonomy all matter here, but pushing one too hard can undermine the others.

QUESTION

What should matter most in the response to an exposed ally's nuclear debate?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Restore confidence fast

The first job is to make the outside guarantee unmistakable before the hedging debate cascades further.

2

Lower demand for latency

What matters most is a political and military framework that reduces the felt need for an independent option.

3

Tolerate some hedging

Some allies will want a latent option even if they do not cross the line, and treating that as pure disloyalty misreads the problem.

4

Protect nonproliferation early

The wider danger is the spread of nuclear latency itself, even if the ally's anxiety is understandable.

ALLIANCES AND AUTONOMY · DECISION · 5 OF 5

Security help without full trust

SCENE

A regional power faces a stronger neighbor and relies on an outside patron for air defense, intelligence, and financing. It wants deeper help, but it does not fully trust that the patron would bear equal risk in a longer crisis. Its cabinet is deciding how to proceed before new basing talks begin.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Outside guarantees can deter and entrap at the same time. The same tie can look like protection or dependence depending on how much trust remains.

QUESTION

From this partner state's side, what should carry the most weight?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Lock in the guarantee

A doubtful guarantee is still better than a thin one. The first job is to make outside backing harder to reverse.

2 **Diversify the backers**

The state should not let one patron decide its room to maneuver. Redundancy in partners is part of security.

3 **Build denial at home**

The safer answer is local resilience, denial tools, and mobilization depth that do not depend on full outside trust.

4 **Keep it issue by issue**

The state should deepen useful security ties without letting one relationship absorb every file of its foreign policy.

SECURITY PRESSURE · LANE

Order, legitimacy, and protection

How you weigh order, legal authority, civilian protection, and bounded action.

0 of 5 answered in this lane

0%

ORDER, LEGITIMACY, AND PROTECTION · DECISION · 1 OF 5

Mass atrocity and outside action

SCENE

Mass civilian killing is underway, the Security Council is blocked, and outside military action would be legally contested. Some governments argue that the level of civilian killing is already so extreme that outside action is justified; others warn that a poorly limited intervention could damage order beyond the immediate crisis.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The central tension is whether the gravity of the harm justifies acting without the level of legal and political grounding that would normally be required.

QUESTION

What should govern the decision?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Keep the legal bar high

However terrible the case, overriding sovereignty without durable grounding can damage order well beyond the crisis at hand.

2

Allow limited protection

If the killing is truly extreme, limited action to stop it can still be defensible even without perfect consensus.

3

Anchor in regional authority

Outside action is more defensible when nearby states define the aim, ceiling, and exit conditions.

4

Reduce harm without widening

Relief, sanctions, monitoring, and documentation may do less, but they avoid normalizing open-ended force on weak authorization.

ORDER, LEGITIMACY, AND PROTECTION · DECISION · 2 OF 5

Aid corridors without clear authorization

SCENE

A government is choking off food and medicine to a besieged region. Outside states consider escorting maritime and air relief corridors, but there is no clear UN authorization and several regional actors worry about mission creep.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The problem is how to relieve urgent civilian harm without quietly turning a relief mission into a broader warfighting mandate.

QUESTION

What should carry the most weight?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Open the corridor

When starvation or siege tactics are already being used, relief access itself becomes the urgent strategic priority.

2

Seek regional cover

Even under pressure, the mission needs regional political ownership if it is going to remain bounded and defensible.

3

Secure authority first

The mission should not move faster than its legal and political basis, even when the delay is painful.

4

Intensify indirect pressure

The better route is harder sanctions, public evidence, and coercive diplomacy short of escorting contested corridors.

Ceasefire versus accountability

SCENE

Mediators think they can likely secure a ceasefire in a brutal war, but only if war-crimes investigations are delayed and monitoring is weaker than many activists want. The debate is over whether stopping the killing, preserving accountability, or building a settlement that can actually hold matters most.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The same compromise can look like prudence to one camp and norm erosion to another.

QUESTION

What is the strongest framing of the tradeoff?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1

Stop the killing first

The strongest justification for compromise is that ending mass harm now outweighs getting the legal architecture right immediately.

2

Accountability sets limits

If accountability can always be delayed in the hardest cases, the norm against atrocity weakens where it matters most.

3

Use a monitored compromise

The better answer is a politically workable ceasefire with regional monitoring and a staged path to accountability.

4

A bad peace recycles harm

A ceasefire without credible enforcement or future constraint can freeze violence temporarily while preserving its drivers.

ORDER, LEGITIMACY, AND PROTECTION · EXPLANATION · 4 OF 5

Sanctions leakage and swing states

SCENE

A wartime coalition wants third-country firms and ports to enforce sanctions more tightly. Several swing states say that looks like wealthy powers exporting the rules and costs of their war through other people's trade networks.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The same resistance can be read as opportunism, autonomy protection, or a real legitimacy objection to how coercion is being organized.

QUESTION

What is the strongest reading of why several swing states resist tighter enforcement?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1 **Leakage changes the war**

The central issue is that sanctions lose strategic meaning when outside actors can profit from evasion without consequence.

2 **Breadth is the real stake**

A broad but imperfect coalition often lasts longer than a cleaner coalition built on coercing reluctant states.

3 **Autonomy is the real stake**

Many middle powers resist not because they support the target, but because they do not want to be turned into enforcement arms for others.

4 **Legal grounding is the real stake**

The more coercive the enforcement becomes, the more it needs a public basis that looks like law rather than improvised hierarchy.

ORDER, LEGITIMACY, AND PROTECTION · EXPLANATION · 5 OF 5

Selective enforcement and intervention memory

SCENE

After mass repression in a weak state, several wealthy powers call for tighter sanctions, no-fly options, and criminal investigations. Many post-colonial states condemn the violence but still resist the enforcement push. They argue the same powers are not equally urgent in other crises.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The resistance can reflect cynicism, sovereignty concerns, or a real judgment about how selective enforcement shapes order.

QUESTION

What is the strongest reading of why many post-colonial states resist harder enforcement?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1 **Selective force is the real issue**

The objection is that powerful states invoke principles unevenly and ask weaker states to live under precedents they do not apply evenly.

2 **The sovereignty barrier still matters**

The deeper concern is that once coercive enforcement becomes easier, weaker states carry the long-run risk.

3 **Regional ownership is missing**

The problem is less the goal than the lack of nearby political ownership that could bound the mission and its aftermath.

4 **The burden is asymmetric**

Many states resist because enforcement often shifts the economic and political burden through other people's trade, diplomacy, and displacement pressures.

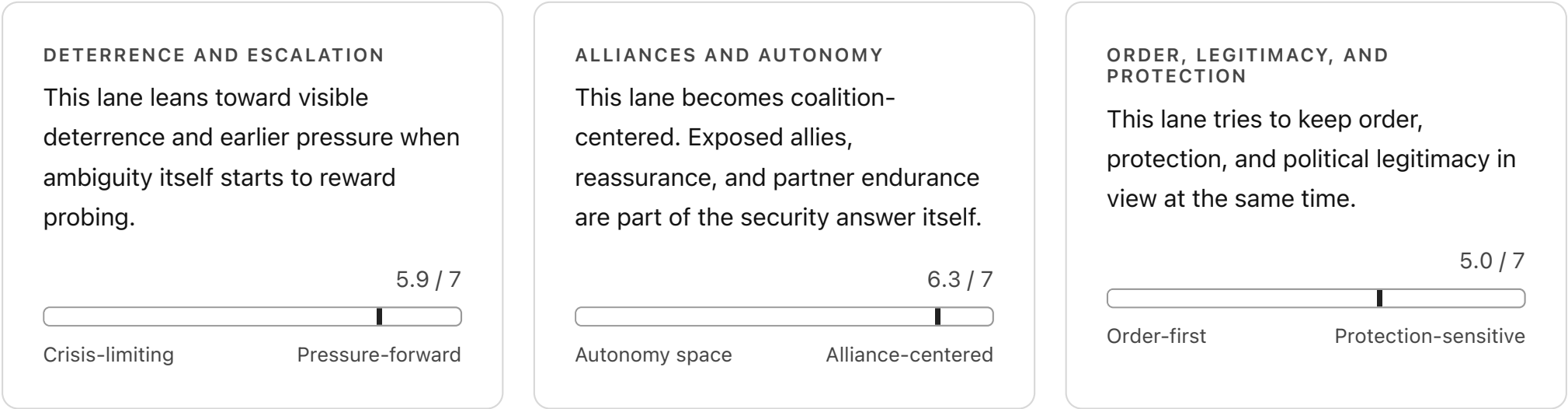
[Generate module result →](#)

[Back to modules](#)

The Foundation remains the baseline. This module shows what changes inside one issue area.

Security read: targeted pressure with limits

You prefer targeted pressure over either passivity or maximal escalation. Alliance durability, crisis ceilings, and legitimacy all stay in view.



What this still leaves open

This style can leave your own threshold for decisive action harder to specify when a crisis suddenly sharpens.

How this relates to your Foundation

This result does not replace your Foundation read. It shows what still tracks, what gets messier, and where this issue area pulls you in a different direction.

REINFORCES

- Your Security read still looks like an overlay on the same baseline rather than a replacement for it.

COMPLICATES

- The actor-lens cards are doing a different job from the decision cards. They track how security logic looks from inside another actor's position, so perspective-modeling does not overwrite your own issue read.

PULLS AWAY

- No strong break from the linked Foundation baseline shows up in this module.
-

Explanation, Decision, and Actor lens

Actor-lens cards stay separate, so perspective-taking does not overwrite your own issue read.

The actor-lens cards are doing a different job from the decision cards. They track how security logic looks from inside another actor's position, so perspective-modeling does not overwrite your own issue read.

What you keep coming back to

- You resist turning every crisis into a single test of resolve.
 - You look for responses that keep options open rather than settle the argument too early.
 - You expect the strongest security logic to shift with theater, partner exposure, and political context.
-

What stays unresolved

This style can leave your own threshold for decisive action harder to specify when a crisis suddenly sharpens.

How to read this module

Framing and scope notes sit down here if you want them.

Framing and scope notes		
MODE Advanced 15 questions · 14 to 18 minutes	IN-FLOW SHORTHAND Security Pressure This is an issue read, not a replacement for the Foundation baseline.	WHAT IT MEASURED pressure versus crisis-limiting instincts; alliance-centered versus autonomy-sensitive coalition instincts; order-first versus protection-sensitive views of force and legitimacy; how explanation cards differ from decision cards when the case sharpens.
WHAT IT DID NOT CLAIM a fixed security identity that overrides the Foundation baseline; a full theory of grand strategy across every theater; role-play or nationality-adjusted answers.		

Module profile

These scores run from 1 to 7 within this module. The labels below name the two poles, not population percentiles, and the main lane read comes from Explanation and Decision cards rather than Actor lens cards.



Evidence log

Lower-level recall of the framings you selected in this module.

Selected framings

QUARANTINE PRESSURE AROUND TAIWAN

Deterrence and escalation · Decision

What should matter most first?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Make the line unmistakable

The first job is to show that pressure below invasion can still change behavior before outside coalitions settle.

EASTERN-FLANK REASSURANCE

Alliances and autonomy · Decision

What should matter most in the posture decision?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Make the promise visible

A forward presence matters first because exposed allies need proof that any attack instantly widens the coalition.

GRAY-ZONE SABOTAGE

Deterrence and escalation · Explanation

What is the most persuasive reading of what the rival is testing?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Test response thresholds

The incidents are mainly testing whether ambiguity lets the rival impose costs without triggering a firm threshold response.

OUTSIDE HELP WITHOUT FORMAL ALIGNMENT

Alliances and autonomy · Decision

What should matter most when outside states offer support?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Use hard external backing

Without stronger outside balancing, legal claims and coast guards will not offset material asymmetry for long.

RETALIATION UNDER SANCTIONS PRESSURE

Deterrence and escalation · Decision

What should matter most in the response?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Restore deterrence visibly

If the answer looks weak, outside strikes and covert pressure may start to look low-cost.

BORDER PRESSURE WHEN A STATE WANTS HELP BUT NOT FULL ALIGNMENT

Alliances and autonomy · Actor lens

From this government's side, which logic looks strongest?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Prepare for a forced choice

If rivalry keeps sharpening, the state may need to bank credibility with Washington before the room to hedge closes.

MASS ATROCITY AND OUTSIDE ACTION

Order, legitimacy, and protection · Decision

What should govern the decision?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Keep the legal bar high

However terrible the case, overriding sovereignty without durable grounding can damage order well beyond the crisis at hand.

NUCLEAR THRESHOLD AND PREVENTIVE FORCE

Deterrence and escalation · Explanation

What is the strongest reading of what this case is mainly about?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Leverage is evaporating

The real issue is that once it starts to feel normal that Iran could reach the nuclear threshold soon, diplomacy loses pressure faster than it can recover it.

SECURITY HELP WITHOUT FULL TRUST

Alliances and autonomy · Decision

From this partner state's side, what should carry the most weight?

AID CORRIDORS WITHOUT CLEAR AUTHORIZATION

Order, legitimacy, and protection · Decision

What should carry the most weight?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Open the corridor

When starvation or siege tactics are already being used, relief access itself becomes the urgent strategic priority.

COERCION BELOW BLOCKADE

Deterrence and escalation · Explanation

What is the strongest reading of why Beijing would prefer coercion below outright blockade?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Normalize a new baseline

The core aim is to make extraordinary interference look routine enough that others slowly adapt to it.

SANCTIONS LEAKAGE AND SWING STATES

Order, legitimacy, and protection · Explanation

What is the strongest reading of why several swing states resist tighter

CEASEFIRE VERSUS ACCOUNTABILITY

Order, legitimacy, and protection · Explanation

What is the strongest framing of the tradeoff?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Stop the killing first

The strongest justification for compromise is that ending mass harm now outweighs getting the legal architecture right immediately.

EXTENDED DETERRENCE AND NUCLEAR HEDGING

Alliances and autonomy · Decision

What should matter most in the response to an exposed ally's nuclear debate?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Restore confidence fast

The first job is to make the outside guarantee unmistakable before the hedging debate cascades further.

SELECTIVE ENFORCEMENT AND INTERVENTION MEMORY

Order, legitimacy, and protection · Explanation

What is the strongest reading of why many post-colonial states resist harder

MOST PERSUASIVE

Lock in the guarantee

A doubtful guarantee is still better than a thin one. The first job is to make outside backing harder to reverse.

enforcement?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Leakage changes the war

The central issue is that sanctions lose strategic meaning when outside actors can profit from evasion without consequence.

enforcement?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Selective force is the real issue

The objection is that powerful states invoke principles unevenly and ask weaker states to live under precedents they do not apply evenly.

[Try another focus-area module](#)

[Retake this module](#)

[Back to Foundation result](#)

[View your Profile](#)

A focused read on chokepoints, industrial policy, AI governance, and strategic dependence

Most cases start from familiar debates about chokepoints, industrial policy, AI governance, and strategic dependence. A smaller set of pressure tests shifts to sanctioned, middle-power, and nonaligned perspectives when the vantage point changes the policy read.

FOUNDATION LINKAGE

How this fits with your Foundation**CURRENT FOUNDATION BASELINE**

Liberal Institutionalism on this device
Hedger · Conditional Solidarist

THIS MODULE PRESSURE-TESTS

- Controls and dependence
- Capacity and industrial policy
- Governance, access, and safety

WHAT CAN CHANGE HERE

This result does not replace the Foundation. It shows how the baseline behaves in one issue area.

MODE

Standard gives you 9 questions and a cleaner first pass. Advanced expands that to 15, with 6 extra cases and a small set of actor-lens pressure tests. In both modes, you can add a backup choice when a second answer genuinely fits.

**Standard**

9 questions · 8 to 10 minutes

**Advanced**

15 questions · 14 to 18 minutes

IN-FLOW SHORTHAND

Tech Power

15 scored items in this mode.

WHAT IT MEASURES

- openness versus control
- market adaptation versus state-capacity building
- national tools versus coordinated governance
- how explanation cards differ from decision cards when the technology case sharpens

WHAT IT DOES NOT CLAIM

- a stable technology identity that overrides the Foundation baseline
- a single answer for semiconductors, AI governance, and digital development alike
- a measure of technical expertise rather than issue instincts

Visible lanes

Each case sits inside one lane so the module reads like a structured set of cases, not one large basket of debates.

CONTROLS AND DEPENDENCE

How you read chokepoints, openness, restriction, and strategic dependence.

0 of 5

0%

CAPACITY AND INDUSTRIAL POLICY

How you think durable advantage is built, financed, and distributed.

0 of 5

0%

GOVERNANCE, ACCESS, AND SAFETY

How you weigh shared rules, access gaps, deployment limits, and enforceable guardrails.

0 of 5

0%

Perspective coverage across the full set of cases

Most cases start from familiar debates in this issue area. A smaller set of actor-lens pressure tests then asks how the same problem looks from exposed partners, rival powers, and nonaligned or development-focused governments.

This keeps the baseline legible without pretending other actors think the same way.

Alliance manager / default coalition-facing logic · Counterparty or rival-power logic · Exposed ally or vulnerable smaller state · Middle-power or nonaligned hedging logic · Developmental / dependency / capacity-constrained actor · Legality / protection / authority logic

How to answer these cases

Read the scene first, then the tradeoff.

- On **Explanation** cards, choose the logic that best explains the case.
- On **Decision** cards, choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.
- On **Actor lens** cards, choose the logic that would look strongest from that actor's own strategic position.

Answer from your own analytic judgment, not from what sounds most moderate or most publicly defensible. If another option also fits, add it as your backup choice.

Foundation comparison is on

This module can compare back to your Foundation result, but it stays a focused issue read rather than replacing the baseline.

0 of 15 answered

0%

TECH POWER · LANE

Controls and dependence

How you read chokepoints, openness, restriction, and strategic dependence.

0 of 5 answered in this lane

0%

Tighter chip controls from the target's side

SCENE

Restrictions tighten again on advanced chips and tooling. In Beijing, officials are deciding what deserves priority next: domestic substitution, selective outside access, broader ecosystem investment, or restraint against panic.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Trying to duplicate every bottleneck is costly. Leaving key layers exposed lets foreign governments set the ceiling on future capacity.

QUESTION

What should matter most first?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Accelerate domestic substitution

The first job is to replace foreign choke points even if the near-term cost is high.

2

Protect access where you still can

Selective cooperation, narrower retaliation, and targeted diplomacy may preserve room that a full break would destroy.

3

Build the wider ecosystem

The real priority is talent, tools, power, finance, and manufacturing depth, not chasing every frontier bottleneck at once.

4

Do not turn every gap into an emergency

Panic can waste resources and harden blocs faster than the restrictions themselves.

CONTROLS AND DEPENDENCE · DECISION · 2 OF 5

Releasing a powerful open-weight model

SCENE

A frontier lab is considering releasing a powerful model with weights that others could freely download and modify.

Advocates point to research diffusion and broader access; critics warn about misuse, proliferation, and the difficulty of containing highly capable systems once the weights are public.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The same release can widen innovation and widen misuse at the same time, so the question is which risk should anchor the policy line.

QUESTION

What should govern the release decision?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Restrict above threshold

Once capability crosses a line, broad release stops being a normal research choice and becomes a misuse and security problem.

2

Use staged release

Access can stay broad, but only through common testing, security baselines, and release protocols that others can also adopt.

3

Keep access broad

Locking powerful models behind a few firms or governments carries its own political and innovation costs. Openness should remain the default.

4

Focus on deployers

The stronger line is to regulate who deploys high-risk systems and how, rather than treating the weights themselves as the whole problem.

CONTROLS AND DEPENDENCE · EXPLANATION · 3 OF 5

Foreign clouds and sovereign stacks**SCENE**

A lower-income state relies on foreign cloud providers, imported data-center hardware, and outside software for most of its digital government functions. Officials are debating local storage rules and a modest sovereign AI stack. Critics call it expensive symbolism. Supporters call it the price of not living inside someone else's infrastructure.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The same move can be about control, bargaining power, development, or politics. The reason you think is primary changes what policy follows.

QUESTION

What is the strongest reading of why some states want a sovereign AI stack?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1 **It is about control**

The main driver is strategic control over sensitive data, compute, and deployment pathways that states no longer trust outsiders to hold.

2 **It is about dependence**

The stronger explanation is that states fear being locked into infrastructures they cannot shape when pressure sharpens.

3 **It is about development room**

For many states the issue is not strategic closure but building enough local room to avoid permanent digital dependence.

4 **It is about fragmentation**

The more persuasive reading is that governments are overlearning security language and underestimating the cost of splintering interoperable systems.

CONTROLS AND DEPENDENCE · ACTOR LENS · 4 OF 5

Nonaligned state under U.S.-China tech pressure

SCENE

A large nonaligned state is deciding whether to join a new technology-security arrangement after fresh U.S. controls and Chinese retaliation threats. In Washington the case is framed as security. In Beijing it is framed as an attempt to freeze hierarchy. This government has to decide which logic best captures its own strategic read before trade and technology talks begin.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

From the outside, both major powers offer ready-made stories. The government still has to decide which diagnosis matters most for its own room to maneuver.

QUESTION

From this government's side, which logic looks strongest?

Optional context

Choose the logic that would look strongest from that actor's own strategic position, not the policy you personally prefer.

1

Strategic denial is real

Some technologies really do alter the balance of power. Governments will act on that whether rivals call it containment or not.

2

Rule design is the issue

Controls become easier to defend when they are narrow, public, and coordinated rather than sprawling and improvised.

3

Hierarchy management is real

The hierarchy critique is partly right: security concerns can be real and still preserve unequal control over technological advancement.

4

Hedging will persist

Many states will protect room to maneuver because both camps offer leverage and dependency in different forms.

A fast infrastructure deal that could create lock-in

SCENE

A lower-income state can get fast data-center finance only from one outside provider that would also run cloud security, maintenance, and most public-sector hosting. Ministers must decide what matters most before signing.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The deal could close a real capacity gap quickly, but it could also lock sensitive systems into one foreign stack.

QUESTION

What should matter most first?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Take the access now

The immediate capability gap is the first problem. A fast buildout matters more than avoiding every future dependency risk.

2

Protect the sensitive layers

The state should move only if it keeps firmer control over security, data, and the parts of the stack that would be hardest to unwind later.

3

Diversify before lock-in

The better answer is multiple suppliers, portable standards, and contract terms that keep one provider from becoming decisive.

4

Pool regionally first

Regional procurement and shared infrastructure may be slower, but they can widen bargaining room more than a fast bilateral deal.

TECH POWER · LANE

Capacity and industrial policy

How you think durable advantage is built, financed, and distributed.

0 of 5 answered in this lane

0%

CAPACITY AND INDUSTRIAL POLICY · DECISION · 1 OF 5

Fab resilience without closing trade

SCENE

A government deeply dependent on Taiwanese and Korean fabs wants more resilience without collapsing open trade. Officials disagree on whether the answer is duplication at home, allied production networks, portfolio redundancy, or simple restraint against overcorrection.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Concentration at the frontier is risky, but trying to duplicate everything can be wasteful enough to weaken the capacity you are trying to build.

QUESTION

What should carry the most weight in the resilience strategy?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1 **Duplicate more at home**

Frontier concentration is itself the vulnerability. Strategic sectors need more domestic slack even when it is expensive.

2 **Build trusted networks**

Resilience comes from a broader allied manufacturing map, not every state trying to rebuild the full stack alone.

3 **Build portfolio depth**

The practical answer is redundancy across design tools, packaging, inventories, and inputs rather than one giant reshoring gesture.

4 **Avoid overcorrection**

Concentration is risky, but duplicating everything can freeze resources and lock in the wrong industrial bets.

CAPACITY AND INDUSTRIAL POLICY · EXPLANATION · 2 OF 5

Compute, cloud, and industrial catch-up

SCENE

A large middle power is deciding whether compute, cloud, and data centers should be treated as strategic public infrastructure or left mainly to the market. Officials agree the country cannot build every layer of the stack. They disagree on what kind of system actually creates durable advantage.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

If you misread where advantage comes from, you can spend heavily and still stay dependent.

QUESTION

What is the strongest reading of how a middle power should build durable AI capacity?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1

Public buildout matters most

Strategic sectors usually do not appear at the needed scale or speed without public finance and infrastructure.

2

Specialization matters most

The stronger model is to pool scale across partners instead of trying to rebuild the whole stack alone.

3

Market adaptation matters most

Government should set guardrails and basic infrastructure, but heavy planning can lock in the wrong bets.

4

Protected depth matters most

Dependence on foreign capital, cloud, or tools creates future vulnerability. Some domestic depth has to be built and sheltered.

CAPACITY AND INDUSTRIAL POLICY · DECISION · 3 OF 5

Public compute and access gaps

SCENE

Universities, startups, and smaller states argue that frontier AI is increasingly shaped by whoever controls the largest compute budgets. Policymakers debate public compute, shared research infrastructure, private scaling, and more

development-focused access strategies.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

The frontier is expensive because it is hard, but that does not answer whether concentrated access is merely efficient or politically distorting.

QUESTION

What should carry the most weight in the response to access concentration?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Build public compute

If compute stays concentrated in a few private actors, broad research access and public oversight will keep shrinking.

2

Share trusted infrastructure

A network of trusted research clouds can widen access without requiring every state to finance a frontier stack alone.

3

Let private scale lead

The frontier is expensive because it is genuinely difficult. Heavy public intervention may spread resources thin without matching private speed.

4

Treat access as development

The core issue is not only frontier competition. It is whether poorer states and public institutions are being locked out of the next production stack.

Allied subsidy races

SCENE

Close partners are subsidizing the same semiconductor and AI sectors, risking duplication and political backlash. Some see healthy redundancy; others see a preventable race for symbolic industrial wins.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

A bit of redundancy can be useful, but too much turns allied resilience into allied competition for the same bottlenecks.

QUESTION

What should carry the most weight when close partners back the same strategic sectors?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Accept some duplication

Strategic industries are too important to optimize only for efficiency. Some overlap is the price of resilience.

2

Negotiate specialization

Partners gain more from complementary roles than from spending public money to outbid each other in the same sectors.

3

Keep national depth

Specialization is useful, but no government wants to discover too late that its most strategic capacity lives abroad.

4

Let market discipline sort

Public subsidy races can spend enormous sums on political symbolism while crowding out more adaptive private investment.

CAPACITY AND INDUSTRIAL POLICY · DECISION · 5 OF 5

Regional public compute

SCENE

Several middle powers are debating whether to pool public compute, cloud capacity, and training programs instead of each chasing a national frontier stack. Finance ministries want scale. Security officials worry pooled systems could dilute control.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

National buildout is politically cleaner, but separate national stacks may be too thin to matter. A regional pool can solve scale and still create new coordination risks.

QUESTION

What should carry the most weight when middle powers consider a shared compute buildout?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Keep national depth

Shared access is useful, but strategic sectors still need national control over their most critical compute and cloud layers.

2

Pool scale regionally

A shared buildout is the strongest path because scale, talent, and bargaining power all improve when middle powers stop duplicating thin national efforts.

3

Fund the missing layers

The smarter approach is targeted public support for power, cloud access, and training rather than one grand frontier gesture.

4

Let the market choose

Governments should widen access and basic infrastructure, but they should not guess too confidently which compute model will age best.

TECH POWER · LANE

Governance, access, and safety

How you weigh shared rules, access gaps, deployment limits, and enforceable guardrails.

0 of 5 answered in this lane

0%

GOVERNANCE, ACCESS, AND SAFETY · DECISION · 1 OF 5

Frontier AI governance

SCENE

Frontier AI capabilities are accelerating. Policymakers debate licensing, compute thresholds, open models, and national-security risk. The underlying dispute is over what kind of governance is strong enough to matter before the field outruns

it.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Move too slowly and guardrails arrive after the capabilities that need them. Move too heavily and you risk locking in the wrong institutions or actors.

QUESTION

What should anchor policy first?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Use hard thresholds

Licensing and compute thresholds are necessary because some risks arrive before markets or informal norms can catch up.

2

Govern with capable partners

The strongest path is shared standards and coordinated restrictions among states that can actually enforce them.

3

Keep innovation open

Heavy gating will entrench incumbents and slow useful progress. Safeguards should stay targeted rather than general.

4

Treat capability as strategic

The first priority is national capability. Governance should not become a back door to long-run self-limitation.

Military AI deployment

SCENE

After a year of rapid battlefield experimentation abroad, a defense ministry is deciding whether to field AI-enabled targeting and battle-management tools before its testing standards are mature. Commanders warn that waiting could leave the force behind a rival. Lawyers and allies warn that rushed deployment could spread unclear doctrine and weak accountability across the coalition.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Speed and caution are both strategic arguments here, so the choice is not simply innovation versus ethics. The immediate question is what should set the deployment threshold before rough practice becomes coalition doctrine.

QUESTION

What should carry the most weight in the deployment choice?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1

Field before the rival sets the baseline

A military that waits for high confidence may discover that its rival set the operational baseline first.

2

Gate deployment through thresholds

Deployment can continue, but only through staged testing, auditable logs, and hard limits on autonomous action.

3

Set coalition baselines first

The bigger danger is close partners racing ahead with different thresholds and incompatible doctrine.

4

Keep responsibility legible

The deepest risk is not only technical error but the erosion of responsibility once command decisions become opaque.

GOVERNANCE, ACCESS, AND SAFETY · ACTOR LENS · 3 OF 5

AI access from a sanctioned state's side

SCENE

The usual debate in Washington and major firms is about trusted suppliers, safeguards, and secure access. A sanctions-constrained middle-income state is looking at the same landscape from a different angle: it wants AI compute and cloud access for education, logistics, and public services, but the fastest outside options could also deepen surveillance exposure and political dependence. Its cabinet is deciding which logic best captures its own position before it commits scarce public money.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

What looks like manageable dependence from the outside can look like future coercive vulnerability from the state's side.

QUESTION

From this government's side, which logic looks strongest?

Optional context

Choose the logic that would look strongest from that actor's own strategic position, not the policy you personally prefer.

1 **Treat it as a sovereignty problem**

The main issue is how to build enough domestic depth in data, talent, and cloud access to reduce future coercive vulnerability.

2 **Treat it as a lock-in problem**

The stronger answer is diversified suppliers and portable standards that keep dependence from hardening into captivity.

3 **Treat it as a scale problem**

Shared compute, training, and procurement may be the only realistic way to widen room to maneuver.

4 **Treat it as an access problem**

For many states the bigger danger is being left out of the technology shift altogether, not becoming too dependent within it.

GOVERNANCE, ACCESS, AND SAFETY · DECISION · 4 OF 5

Model incidents and mandatory reporting

SCENE

A frontier model contributes to a serious cyber and biosecurity incident. Governments now debate whether reporting should become mandatory, whether sensitive details should stay national, and whether liability should shift toward deployers rather than model developers alone.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

Disclosure can make safety governance real, but it can also expose information that governments and firms do not want to standardize publicly.

QUESTION

What should matter most after a serious model incident?

Optional context

Choose the consideration that should carry the most weight in the response.

1 **Mandate shared reporting**

Serious incidents should trigger common disclosure and audit baselines or governance will remain mostly rhetorical.

2 **Keep sensitive reporting national**

Governments should require reporting, but the most consequential incidents belong in controlled national channels rather than broad shared disclosure.

3 **Shift liability to deployment**

The better lever is to make downstream deployers bear more responsibility instead of assuming model developers are the only governance choke point.

4 **Avoid overgeneralizing**

A serious incident matters, but rushing to one broad reporting regime may harden rules before the causal picture is actually clear.

SCENE

A club of technically capable states is close to setting AI testing and deployment standards that many others will have to live with. Supporters say only capable states can move fast enough. Critics say the process will set global defaults without broad voice.

WHAT MAKES THIS HARD

A narrow club may be easier to enforce, but that does not settle whether others will see the rules as legitimate, development-friendly, or compatible with regulatory autonomy.

QUESTION

What is the deeper issue when a small club starts setting global AI standards?

Optional context

Choose the option that best explains what is driving the case.

1

Capable states must lead

The first requirement is enforceable standards, and only a narrow set of states currently has the technical and regulatory capacity to build them fast enough.

2

Legitimacy needs broader voice

Rules that others must live under will be weaker in the long run if the writers treat broad participation as optional.

3

The development costs are hidden

The sharper issue is that compliance costs and access barriers may fall hardest on states that were barely in the room when the rules were drafted.

4

Regulatory room still matters

A state may want common baselines and still resist standards that narrow domestic room to govern its own deployment choices.

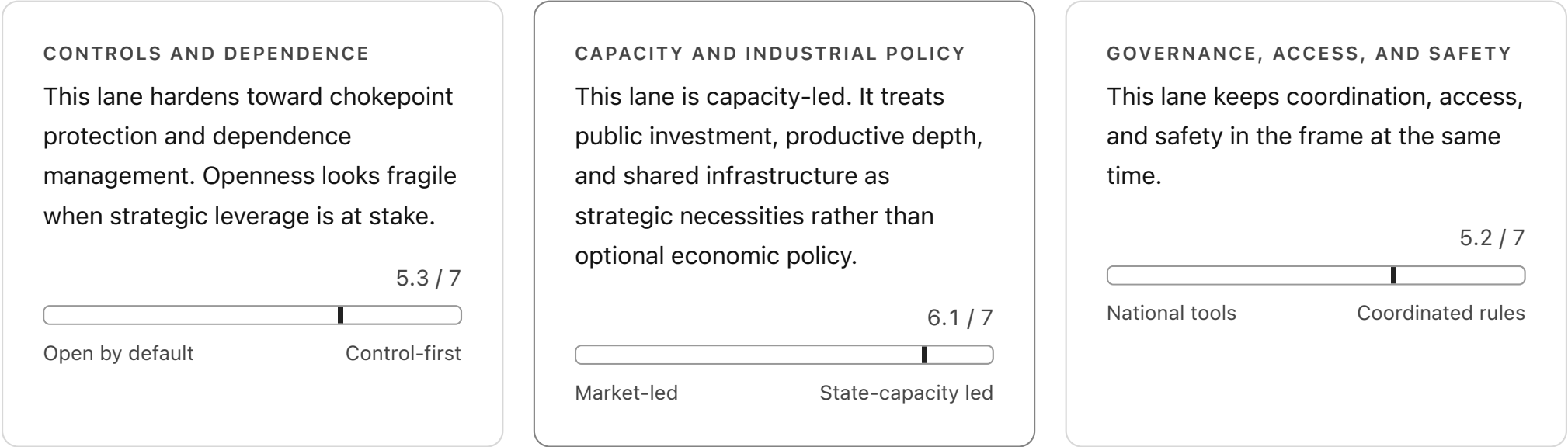
[Generate module result →](#)

[Back to modules](#)

The Foundation remains the baseline. This module shows what changes inside one issue area.

Technology read: selective control with coordination

You are open to controls, capacity-building, and coordinated rules, but you do not want one tool to dominate every technology problem.



What this still leaves open

This style can leave your threshold for harder control or broader openness less explicit than the policy environment may demand.

FOUNDATION LINKAGE

How this relates to your Foundation

This result does not replace your Foundation read. It shows what still tracks, what gets messier, and where this issue area pulls you in a different direction.

REINFORCES

- Your Technology read still looks like an overlay on the same baseline rather than a replacement for it.

COMPLICATES

- Your actor-lens cards make dependency and bargaining room look sharper than your own policy choices do. That perspective read is tracked separately so modeling another state's incentives does not overwrite your technology judgment.

PULLS AWAY

- No strong break from the linked Foundation baseline shows up in this module.
-

Explanation, Decision, and Actor lens

Actor-lens cards stay separate, so perspective-taking does not overwrite your own issue read.

Your actor-lens cards make dependency and bargaining room look sharper than your own policy choices do. That perspective read is tracked separately so modeling another state's incentives does not overwrite your technology judgment.

What you keep coming back to

- You expect the right answer to shift across semiconductors, frontier AI, and digital development.
 - You are open to both controls and openness depending on the strategic setting.
 - You look for selective intervention rather than a fully market-led or fully closed model.
-

What stays unresolved

This style can leave your threshold for harder control or broader openness less explicit than the policy environment may demand.

How to read this module

Framing and scope notes sit down here if you want them.

Framing and scope notes		
MODE Advanced 15 questions · 14 to 18 minutes	IN-FLOW SHORTHAND Tech Power This is an issue read, not a replacement for the Foundation baseline.	WHAT IT MEASURED openness versus control; market adaptation versus state-capacity building; national tools versus coordinated governance; how explanation cards differ from decision cards when the technology case sharpens.
WHAT IT DID NOT CLAIM a stable technology identity that overrides the Foundation baseline; a single answer for semiconductors, AI governance, and digital development alike; a measure of technical expertise rather than issue instincts.		

Module profile

These scores run from 1 to 7 within this module. The labels below name the two poles, not population percentiles, and the main lane read comes from Explanation and Decision cards rather than Actor lens cards.

Control posture

5.2 / 7



Governance lens

4.3 / 7



Industrial lens

5.1 / 7



AI risk lens

4.8 / 7



Evidence log

Lower-level recall of the framings you selected in this module.

Selected framings

TIGHTER CHIP CONTROLS FROM THE TARGET'S SIDE

Controls and dependence · Decision

What should matter most first?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Accelerate domestic substitution

The first job is to replace foreign choke points even if the near-term cost is high.

FAB RESILIENCE WITHOUT CLOSING TRADE

Capacity and industrial policy · Decision

What should carry the most weight in the resilience strategy?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Duplicate more at home

Frontier concentration is itself the vulnerability. Strategic sectors need more domestic slack even when it is expensive.

RELEASING A POWERFUL OPEN-WEIGHT MODEL

Controls and dependence · Decision

What should govern the release decision?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Restrict above threshold

Once capability crosses a line, broad release stops being a normal research choice and becomes a misuse and security problem.

COMPUTE, CLOUD, AND INDUSTRIAL CATCH-UP

Capacity and industrial policy · Explanation

What is the strongest reading of how a middle power should build durable AI capacity?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Public buildout matters most

Strategic sectors usually do not appear at the needed scale or speed without public

FOREIGN CLOUDS AND SOVEREIGN STACKS

Controls and dependence · Explanation

What is the strongest reading of why some states want a sovereign AI stack?

MOST PERSUASIVE

It is about control

The main driver is strategic control over sensitive data, compute, and deployment pathways that states no longer trust outsiders to hold.

PUBLIC COMPUTE AND ACCESS GAPS

Capacity and industrial policy · Decision

What should carry the most weight in the response to access concentration?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Build public compute

If compute stays concentrated in a few private actors, broad research access and public oversight will keep shrinking.

FRONTIER AI GOVERNANCE

Governance, access, and safety · Decision

What should anchor policy first?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Use hard thresholds

Licensing and compute thresholds are necessary because some risks arrive before markets or informal norms can catch up.

NONALIGNED STATE UNDER U.S.-CHINA TECH PRESSURE

Controls and dependence · Actor lens

From this government's side, which logic looks strongest?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Strategic denial is real

Some technologies really do alter the balance of power. Governments will act on that whether rivals call it containment or not.

REGIONAL PUBLIC COMPUTE

Capacity and industrial policy · Decision

finance and infrastructure.

MILITARY AI DEPLOYMENT

Governance, access, and safety · Decision

What should carry the most weight in the deployment choice?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Field before the rival sets the baseline

A military that waits for high confidence may discover that its rival set the operational baseline first.

A FAST INFRASTRUCTURE DEAL THAT COULD CREATE LOCK-IN

Controls and dependence · Decision

What should matter most first?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Take the access now

The immediate capability gap is the first problem. A fast buildout matters more than avoiding every future dependency risk.

MODEL INCIDENTS AND MANDATORY REPORTING

AI ACCESS FROM A SANCTIONED STATE'S SIDE

Governance, access, and safety · Actor lens

From this government's side, which logic looks strongest?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Treat it as a sovereignty problem

The main issue is how to build enough domestic depth in data, talent, and cloud access to reduce future coercive vulnerability.

ALLIED SUBSIDY RACES

Capacity and industrial policy · Decision

What should carry the most weight when close partners back the same strategic sectors?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Accept some duplication

Strategic industries are too important to optimize only for efficiency. Some overlap is the price of resilience.

AI STANDARDS WITHOUT BROAD VOICE

Governance, access, and safety · Explanation

What should carry the most weight when middle powers consider a shared compute buildout?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Keep national depth

Shared access is useful, but strategic sectors still need national control over their most critical compute and cloud layers.

Governance, access, and safety · Decision

What should matter most after a serious model incident?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Mandate shared reporting

Serious incidents should trigger common disclosure and audit baselines or governance will remain mostly rhetorical.

What is the deeper issue when a small club starts setting global AI standards?

MOST PERSUASIVE

Capable states must lead

The first requirement is enforceable standards, and only a narrow set of states currently has the technical and regulatory capacity to build them fast enough.

[Try another focus-area module](#)

[Retake this module](#)

[Back to Foundation result](#)

[View your Profile](#)

Democratic Guardrailist

- FRONTIER-RISK FIRST
- PRECAUTION-FIRST
- COMPETITIVE HEDGER

You read AI governance mainly through democratic guardrailist logic. Your strongest signals sit around public oversight and legitimacy and rule-setting. In practical terms, you lean toward frontier-risk first and precaution-first rather than treating AI as a simple pro- or anti-technology question.

STRONGEST AXIS SIGNALS



GOVERNING INSTINCT

Keep frontier AI answerable to public authority so governance is not quietly privatized by the actors building the systems.

TENSION TO WATCH

You give real weight to severe frontier risk while staying relatively open to diffusion. The hard question is where you would start to draw real limits.

MAIN SIGNAL

Public oversight (7.0) - Legitimacy and rule-setting (7.0) - Military role (6.7)

NEXT STEP

Keep this beside the IR Foundation in Profile rather than treating it as a replacement for the baseline.

Open Profile →

Trust and coverage

This is a structured read within the current compass, not a claim that the field divides into fixed camps. The archetype is the closest modeled fit, not a final or exhaustive identity. Methods explains the limits →

How this AI result relates to your IR baseline

Read this as a relationship between two saved layers in the same project, not as a rewritten Foundation identity or a single combined score.

IR BASELINE ON THIS DEVICE

Liberal Institutional

Hedger · Conditional Solidarist

COMPARED WITH YOUR IR BASELINE

- public legitimacy and institutional design are mutually reinforcing
- rules should be contestable, not purely expert-defined
- process-heavy legitimacy can slow urgent action

SO WHAT THIS ADDS

You are likely to support oversight bodies, rights-protective rules, and more transparent public governance of frontier development.

[Open Profile →](#)

Read the longer archetype explanation

MOSTLY SETTLED

Governing instinct

Keep frontier AI answerable to public authority so governance is not quietly privatized by the actors building the systems.

PROFILE SHAPE

Mostly settled

This names how far the top archetype sits from nearby profiles. It is a reading aid, not a confidence score.

SHORT READ

You want frontier AI governed by institutions that can be questioned, contested, and held answerable in public.

MAIN SIGNALS

Public oversight (7.0) - Legitimacy and rule-setting (7.0) - Military role (6.7)

Likely policy package

These are the policy moves your answers make easier to defend when the tradeoffs get sharp.

FRONTIER RELEASE THRESHOLDS

Thresholds before scale

You are more willing to accept delay, stronger evaluation, and narrower release when capabilities begin to look dangerous.

OVERSIGHT AND ENFORCEMENT

Stronger external supervision

You want more outside authority over frontier development and are less satisfied with voluntary internal governance alone.

INTERNATIONAL ORDER

Selective coordination under rivalry

You see real competition and real coordination needs, so your instinct is selective rather than doctrinal.

OPENNESS AND DIFFUSION

Openness as default bias

You are more likely to see broad access and lower barriers as protection against capture and dependence, not just as a risk.

DEFENSE AND SECURITY USE

Bounded defense integration

You see a stronger case for tightly bounded military and intelligence use if the alternative is serious strategic vulnerability.

HUMAN FUTURE

Allow transformative upside

You are more open to transformative futures if the upside is large enough and the governance case still holds.

What this means for world order

How this result reads once the question becomes rivalry, dependence, standards, and coordination.

Likely to favor public legitimacy and institutional accountability over fast technocratic coordination.

Often attentive to whether governance is answerable to citizens, not only to states or labs.

More likely to worry that governance built without civic legitimacy will fail politically even if it looks technically elegant.

What would change your mind

A strong worldview should also say what evidence could make it rethink itself.

Strong evidence that public institutions cannot build or hire enough expertise to supervise credibly.

Evidence that certain technocratic or lab-led mechanisms outperform public processes without becoming self-serving.

Repeated cases where formal accountability structures exist on paper but fail to shape actual deployment behavior.

Pressure points

These are the places where your principles and strategic instincts may tug in different directions.

Open diffusion under high-risk assumptions

You give real weight to severe frontier risk while staying relatively open to diffusion. The hard question is where you would start to draw real limits.

Transformation under supervision

You are more open to transformative futures, but only under stronger public supervision. The question is whether institutions can govern futures they barely understand.

Boundary cases

This shows the nearest alternative to your result and the archetype furthest from your instincts.

RUNNER-UP COMPARISON

Why you are not Strategic Competitor

Compared with Strategic Competitor, your result separated most on bounded defense integration and competition-first assumptions. That is why you landed in Democratic Guardrailist rather than next door.

MOST DISTANT ARCHETYPE

Farthest from Open Ecosystem Builder

Your profile is farthest from Open Ecosystem Builder because your instincts on external public oversight and precaution and threshold-setting point in a different direction.

Best critique of your worldview

Your critics will say that democratic legitimacy is essential but often too slow, too fragmented, or too technically thin to supervise frontier systems well in real time.

SIT WITH THIS QUESTION

How do you make governance publicly answerable without making it performative, symbolic, or too slow to matter?

EIGHT DIMENSIONS

Axis profile

These scores run from 1 to 7 in this model. They are positions on the axes, not rankings against other people.

Risk horizon

6 / 7



You give substantial weight to severe frontier or catastrophic risks when thinking about governance.

Deployment pace

5.3 / 7



You are more willing to slow deployment when evidence turns concerning.

Public oversight

7 / 7



You prefer stronger public or state supervision over frontier AI development.

Competition vs coordination

4.8 / 7



You hedge: competition is real, but so is the need for selective coordination.

Openness vs control

3.2 / 7



You do not treat either openness or control as a universal default.

Military role

6.7 / 7



You see a stronger case for bounded defense use of frontier AI.

Legitimacy and rule-setting

7 / 7



You want rules to be visibly grounded in public institutions or international processes.

Human future

3.5 / 7



You are open to transformation, but you want institutions to absorb it in a more managed way.

Where to go next

These readings help you deepen this result, test it against its best critics, and keep exploring inside the project.

START HERE

Shared field maps and baseline texts before you settle into one governance camp.

USE THE PRODUCT

Browse the AI atlas — See nearby archetypes and the reading shelves that sit beside them.

AI Governance: A Research Agenda

Allan Dafoe · 2018

Still one of the clearest maps of the field: alignment, concentration, institutional design, misuse, and global governance.

International AI Safety Report 2025

Independent international expert group · 2025

Useful as a shared scientific baseline for advanced-AI safety debates across countries rather than a single camp's framing.

OECD AI Principles

OECD · 2019 / updated 2023

A high-level intergovernmental baseline for trustworthy AI, rights, robustness, and accountability.

NIST AI RMF: Generative AI Profile

NIST · 2024

Shows how governance looks when translated into operational risk-management language.

GO DEEPER

Operational frameworks, official documents, and live policy tools that show how these debates cash out in practice.

USE THE PRODUCT

Read methods — See the scope, guardrails, and limits behind the whole project.

Open references — Use the broader bibliography when you want a wider shelf than the result page alone.

Common Elements of Frontier AI Safety Policies

METR · 2025 / 2026 site updates

Synthesizes what labs are actually doing around thresholds, model evaluations, weight security, and deployment mitigations.

Responsible Scaling Policy

Anthropic · 2026 update

A living example of how a frontier lab publicly structures capability thresholds and safeguards.

Updated Preparedness Framework

OpenAI · 2025

Useful for comparing another frontier-lab approach to severe-risk measurement and mitigation.

Safety Cases at AISI

AI Security Institute · 2026

Pushes the debate from generic principles toward structured arguments that a system is safe in a given context.

CHALLENGE YOUR VIEW

The strongest objections to the instincts your result is likely to reward. These are worth reading carefully rather than dismissing.

USE THE PRODUCT

Cross-check in IR modules —
Pressure-test the AI result against
the Security and Technology
overlays.

When Speed Kills: Lethal Autonomous Weapon Systems and the Dangers of Rushing to Weaponize AI

Michael Horowitz · 2019

A strong security-focused critique of governance that ignores the pace pressures created by military competition.

Incompleteness: A Regulatory Design Challenge for AI

Gillian Hadfield · 2019

A useful challenge to the idea that more democratic procedure automatically yields governance that can

keep up with fast-moving systems.

On the Dangers of Stochastic Parrots

Emily M. Bender, Timnit Gebru, Angelina McMillan-Major, Shmargaret Shmitchell · 2021

The canonical present-harms critique of scale-first language-model development.

Harms of AI

Daron Acemoglu · 2021

A strong challenge to governance approaches that assume more AI or more state support is obviously beneficial.

Atlas of AI

Kate Crawford · 2021

A material critique of AI as an extractive infrastructure, not just a software or safety problem.

Open-Sourcing Highly Capable Foundation Models

Elizabeth Seger et al. · 2023

Useful when testing openness-first instincts against the strongest misuse and proliferation critique.

WIDEN THE FRAME

How these debates look beyond U.S. and European defaults, including Chinese and broader global-governance lenses.

USE THE PRODUCT

Keep browsing the shelf — Move from these entry points into the full bibliography when you want more range.

State of AI Safety in China

Concordia AI · 2025

The best single English-language guide to the diversity and maturation of Chinese AI safety discourse.

Global AI Governance Initiative

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the PRC · 2023

Essential for understanding China's official framing around sovereignty, development, safety, and multilateral governance.

Global AI Governance Action Plan

2025 World AI Conference and High-Level Meeting on Global AI Governance · 2025

A current official text on cooperation, development, and global-governance architecture beyond a U.S.-centric frame.

Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

UNESCO · 2021

Useful for human-rights, dignity, and global ethics framing that extends beyond frontier-lab discourse.

About this profile

Archetype labels are shorthand, not verdicts. The scores show positions in this model, not population percentiles. This is still an early-stage inventory covering a defined set of AI governance debates, not the whole field.

Comparing results with someone else?

Compare the axis profile, tensions, and reading buckets as well as the headline archetype. The most useful disagreements usually show up in the tradeoffs, not only in the top label.

Share feedback on this module →

Your baseline stays closest to Liberal Institutionalism, but tech power changes the emphasis.

The profile keeps returning to institutional design, credible commitment, and whether coordination changes incentives rather than merely decorating them. The clearest shift appears under Tech Power pressure, which means the baseline is useful but not automatic across every issue.

- FOUNDATION
- SECURITY
- TECHNOLOGY
- AI

BASELINE
Liberal Institutionalism
Hedger · Conditional Solidarist

WHAT STAYED STEADY
Across the saved layers, you keep coming back to rules, coordination, and whether institutions can change behavior. Security and Technology both keep the baseline in view, even where one domain pulls harder. In AI, that same thread shows up in a focus on public legitimacy, rights, and visible accountability.

BIGGEST SHIFT
What shifts most: Tech Power pushes you more political-economy attuned.

PRESSURE POINT
Tech Power is the clearest pressure test. It pushes you more political-economy attuned.

COMPLETED LAYERS
Saved layers: Foundation, Security, Technology, and AI.

BROWSE
Open the Atlas
Compare this profile against nearby recurring patterns in the model.

What stays steady and what shifts

A short read of the Foundation and completed modules on this device.

STABLE THREAD

Across the saved layers, you keep coming back to rules, coordination, and whether institutions can change behavior. Security and Technology both keep the baseline in view, even where one domain pulls harder. In AI, that same thread shows up in a focus on public legitimacy, rights, and visible accountability.

PRESSURE SHIFTS

Tech Power is the clearest pressure point. It pushes you more political-economy attuned. The baseline survives, but one issue domain clearly changes which cost you weight first. The AI layer adds pressure toward public legitimacy and rights when speed or secrecy starts to dominate.

REASONING STYLE

You usually start with rules, incentives, and whether coordination can survive stress. You reason from a clear baseline, but you change emphasis when the case becomes more concrete. When power expands quickly, you ask how it stays publicly accountable.

Longer profile interpretation

LAYER RELATIONSHIPS

How the saved layers connect

The Foundation stays as the anchor. Saved layers show where it holds, sharpens, or starts to pull in different directions.

FOUNDATION

ANCHOR

Liberal Institutional

Hedger · Conditional Solidarist

Open Foundation result →

SECURITY

COMPLICATES

Security read: targeted pressure with limits

You prefer targeted pressure over either passivity or maximal escalation. Alliance durability, crisis ceilings, and legitimacy all stay in view.

Open overlay result →

TECHNOLOGY

COMPLICATES

Technology read: selective control with coordination

You are open to controls, capacity-building, and coordinated rules, but you do not want one tool to dominate every technology problem.

Open overlay result →

CONTINUITIES

What keeps returning

Across the saved layers, you keep coming back to rules, coordination, and whether institutions can change behavior. Security and Technology both keep the baseline in view, even where one domain pulls harder. In AI, that same thread shows up in a focus on public legitimacy, rights, and visible accountability.

TENSIONS

Where pressure changes the read

Tech Power is the clearest pressure point. It pushes you more political-economy attuned. The baseline survives, but one issue domain clearly changes which cost you weight first. The AI layer adds pressure toward public legitimacy and rights when speed or secrecy starts to dominate.

REASONING STYLE

How you tend to sort cases

You usually start with rules, incentives, and whether coordination can survive stress. You reason from a

AI GOVERNANCE

REINFORCES

Democratic Guardrailist

You think AI governance has to be both effective and publicly legitimate; technical governance without visible accountability is not enough.

Open AI result →

clear baseline, but you change emphasis when the case becomes more concrete. When power expands quickly, you ask how it stays publicly accountable.

Built from Foundation, Security, Technology, and AI. The page reads them as one mosaic, not a single score.

Where the overlays move the baseline

Your Foundation result is still the baseline. Saved modules show where issue-specific cases reinforce it, complicate it, or pull against it.

Security rivalry

■ Foundation 5.3 ● Security Pressure 5.9 ■ Tech Power 5.8

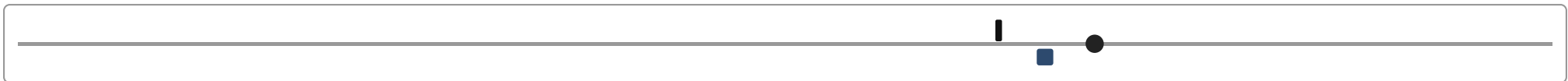


Less rivalry-centered

Rivalry-centered

Institutions and rules

■ Foundation 4.8 ● Security Pressure 5.2 ■ Tech Power 5.0



Institutions as power mirrors

Institutions matter

Domestic politics

Foundation 5.7 Tech Power 6.0



System-pressure first Domestic-politics aware

Identity and legitimacy

Foundation 5.0



Norm-skeptical Legitimacy-aware

Markets and dependence

Foundation 5.8 Tech Power 6.5



Security-and-diplomacy first Political-economy attuned

Restraint and advantage

Foundation 5.0 Security Pressure 4.4 Tech Power 4.7



Maximization first Restraint first

Order and justice

Foundation 4.7 Security Pressure 4.4



Justice-sensitive Order-first

What shifts most: Tech Power pushes you more political-economy attuned.

Atlas

Atlas gives plain-English names to patterns that show up repeatedly in the current model. It is a browsing aid, not a live population map.

NEAREST ATLAS PATTERN

Cross-Pressured Synthesizer

MOSTLY LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Also overlaps with Social Constructivist and Critical Political Economist.

This pattern does not settle into one clean doctrine: different domains or question types pull the profile in materially different directions.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition		Medium
Institutions		Medium
Legitimacy		Medium
Political economy		Medium
Restraint		Medium

Under pressure: Security often hardens the diagnosis faster than the endorsement, while Technology can reveal a different balance between control, governance, and access.

WHAT USUALLY DRIVES IT

- Security and Technology do not point the same way
- Explanation and choice can diverge
- One summary line leaves too much out

NEARBY PATTERNS

Bridge Builder Legitimacy Reader

[Read this pattern](#) [Browse Atlas](#)

What to open next

The profile works best when it gives you one or two clear next moves inside the same map.

BROWSE

Open the Atlas

Compare this profile against nearby recurring patterns in the model.

AI layer

The AI Governance Compass belongs to the same project, but it does not rewrite your IR baseline. Read it as a connected layer, not a replacement label.

Liberal Institutionalist

DEMOCRATIC GUARDRAILIST

LEGITIMACY-FIRST INSTITUTIONAL PROFILE

Short read

You think AI governance has to be both effective and publicly legitimate; technical governance without visible accountability is not enough.

WHERE THEY ALIGN

- public legitimacy and institutional design are mutually reinforcing
- rules should be contestable, not purely expert-defined

WHERE THEY MAY CONFLICT

- process-heavy legitimacy can slow urgent action
- democratic structures can struggle with high-speed frontier dynamics

WHAT THIS COMBINATION IMPLIES

You are likely to support oversight bodies, rights-protective rules, and more transparent public governance of frontier development.

AI result: You read AI governance mainly through democratic guardrailist logic. Your strongest signals sit around public oversight and legitimacy and rule-setting. In practical terms, you lean toward frontier-risk first and precaution-first rather than treating AI as a simple pro- or anti-technology question.
Open AI result →

Issue overlays you've completed

Each completed IR module sits beside the Foundation as a domain-specific pressure test.

TECHNOLOGY

Technology read: selective control with coordination

A focused read on chokepoints, industrial policy, AI governance, and strategic dependence

You are open to controls, capacity-building, and coordinated rules, but you do not want one tool to dominate every technology problem.

Controls and dependence5.3 / 7

Open by defaultControl-first

This lane hardens toward chokepoint protection and dependence management. Openness looks fragile when strategic leverage is at stake.

Capacity and industrial policy6.1 / 7

Market-ledState-capacity led

This lane is capacity-led. It treats public investment, productive depth, and shared infrastructure as strategic necessities rather than optional economic policy.

Governance, access, and safety5.2 / 7

National toolsCoordinated rules

This lane keeps coordination, access, and safety in the frame at the same time.

SECURITY

Security read: targeted pressure with limits

A focused read on deterrence, alliances, escalation, and the legitimacy of force

You prefer targeted pressure over either passivity or maximal escalation. Alliance durability, crisis ceilings, and legitimacy all stay in view.

Deterrence and escalation5.9 / 7

Crisis-limitingPressure-forward

This lane leans toward visible deterrence and earlier pressure when ambiguity itself starts to reward probing.

Alliances and autonomy6.3 / 7

Autonomy spaceAlliance-centered

This lane becomes coalition-centered. Exposed allies, reassurance, and partner endurance are part of the security answer itself.

Order, legitimacy, and protection5.0 / 7

Order-firstProtection-sensitive

This lane tries to keep order, protection, and political legitimacy in view at the same time.

EXPLANATION, DECISION, AND ACTOR LENS

Your actor-lens cards make dependency and bargaining room look sharper than your own policy choices do. That perspective read is

tracked separately so modeling another state's incentives does not overwrite your technology judgment.

[View full result →](#)

EXPLANATION, DECISION, AND ACTOR LENS

The actor-lens cards are doing a different job from the decision cards. They track how security logic looks from inside another actor's

position, so perspective-modeling does not overwrite your own issue read.

[View full result →](#)

APPENDIX

Evidence and detail

Open the drawers below for the saved Foundation result and the lower-evidence module recall on this device.

Foundation result

Foundation anchors

Technology evidence log

Security evidence log

Recurring profile patterns in the current model

Atlas is a browse map of patterns that show up repeatedly in the current inventory. It is not a live user distribution, and it is not claiming that people fall into fixed natural kinds.

READING NOTE

The inventory runs on continuous dimensions. These names are plain-English labels for patterns that show up repeatedly in the current model, not percentiles or exhaustive IR types.

Some traditions and strategic cultures are still under-modeled. The point is to help you browse nearby patterns without pretending the quiz is more precise than it is.

ATLAS PATTERN

Bridge Builder

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Also overlaps with Social Constructivist and Strategic Realist.
This pattern keeps several neighboring arguments in play and looks for workable overlap before it reaches for a harder camp.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition	☐ ☐ ☐	Medium
Institutions	☐ ☐ ☐	Medium

ATLAS PATTERN

Constraint-First Realist

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY STRATEGIC REALIST

This pattern starts from rivalry and constraint, but it stays wary of overreach and looks for ceilings before it reaches for a harder line.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition	☐ ☐ ☐	High
Institutions	☐ ☐ ☐	Low

Legitimacy



Medium

Political economy



Medium

Restraint



Medium

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Several dimensions stay near the middle

No clean break between the top traditions

Order and justice both stay live

Read this pattern

Legitimacy



Low

Political economy



Low

Restraint



High

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Rivalry stays front and center

Overextension looks costly

Order usually outranks moral ambition

Read this pattern

ATLAS PATTERN

Competitive Balancer

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY STRATEGIC REALIST

This pattern returns quickly to rivalry, leverage, and credible positioning, with more willingness to press advantage when the opening looks real.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition



High

Institutions



Low

Legitimacy



Low

ATLAS PATTERN

Coalition Pragmatist

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Also overlaps with Strategic Realist and Social Constructivist. This pattern prefers workable coordination and durable partner alignment over either rigid bloc discipline or go-it-alone autonomy.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition



Medium

Institutions



High

Political economy

☐☒☐

Medium

Restraint

☒☐☐

Low

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Rivalry organizes the case

Leverage is there to be used

Restraint gives way sooner

Read this pattern

Legitimacy

☐☒☐

Medium

Political economy

☐☒☐

Medium

Restraint

☐☒☒

High

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Partners must be able to carry the policy

Institutions help when they work

Pressure is weighed against coalition durability

Read this pattern

ATLAS PATTERN

Institution Builder

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Also overlaps with Social Constructivist.

This pattern starts with rules, monitoring, and repeated cooperation as the best way to hold order together over time.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition

☐☐☐

Low

Institutions

☐☒☒

High

Legitimacy

☐☒☐

Medium

ATLAS PATTERN

Legitimacy Reader

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY SOCIAL CONSTRUCTIVIST

Also overlaps with Liberal Institutionalist.

This pattern keeps asking how identity, recognition, and legitimacy shape the meaning of power, threat, and cooperation.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition

☐☒☐

Medium

Institutions

☐☒☐

Medium

Legitimacy

☐☒☒

High

Political economy ☐ ☐ ☐ Low

Restraint ☐ ☒ ☐ Medium

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Rules need enforcement and trust

Domestic capacity shapes credible commitments

Hard rivalry is not the default lens

Read this pattern

Political economy ☐ ☒ ☐ Medium

Restraint ☐ ☒ ☐ Medium

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Legitimacy is part of the causal story

The meaning of a move depends on who makes it

Order debates rarely feel settled

Read this pattern

ATLAS PATTERN

Justice-Forward Solidarist

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY SOCIAL CONSTRUCTIVIST

Also overlaps with Liberal Institutionalism.

This pattern keeps open the possibility that severe moral stakes can outweigh strict non-intervention, especially when legitimacy and protection pull together.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition ☐ ☐ ☐ Low

Institutions ☐ ☒ ☐ Medium

Legitimacy ☐ ☒ ☒ High

Political economy ☐ ☒ ☐ Medium

ATLAS PATTERN

Structural Inequality Critic

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY CRITICAL POLITICAL ECONOMIST

This pattern reads world politics through leverage, dependence, and unequal control over finance, production, and rule-setting.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition ☐ ☒ ☐ Medium

Institutions ☐ ☐ ☐ Low

Legitimacy ☐ ☒ ☐ Medium

Political economy ☐ ☒ ☒ High

Restraint

☒☒☐

Medium

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Civilian protection stays visible

Sovereignty is important but not absolute

Legitimacy and justice are read together

Read this pattern

Restraint

☐☒☒

Medium

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Hierarchy sits behind formal equality

Institutions can carry built-in advantage

Adjustment costs usually fall unevenly

Read this pattern

ATLAS PATTERN

Development-Sovereignty Builder

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY CRITICAL POLITICAL ECONOMIST

Also overlaps with Liberal Institutional.

This pattern starts with policy room, productive depth, and the need to avoid forms of dependence that close off future choice.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition

☐☒☒

Medium

Institutions

☐☒☒

Medium

Legitimacy

☐☐☐

Low

ATLAS PATTERN

Cross-Pressured Synthesizer

PRIMARY FAMILY CUE

MOSTLY LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Also overlaps with Social Constructivist and Critical Political Economist.

This pattern does not settle into one clean doctrine: different domains or question types pull the profile in materially different directions.

PATTERN FINGERPRINT

Competition

☐☒☒

Medium

Institutions

☐☒☒

Medium

Legitimacy

☐☒☒

Medium

Political economy

☐☒☒

Medium

Political economy



High

Restraint



Medium

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Capacity and autonomy travel together

Lock-in is a strategic risk

Development needs shape external choices

Read this pattern

Political economy



Medium

Restraint



Medium

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Security and Technology do not point the same way

Explanation and choice can diverge

One summary line leaves too much out

Read this pattern

CONTINUE

Take the Foundation

Browse the field guide

View Profile

Explore the perspectives

International Relations theory is not a single political spectrum. The traditions below disagree about what drives world politics, what evidence matters most, and what kinds of arguments carry the most weight. This page is a field guide to the current Foundation, module, and Profile model, not a claim that people fit perfectly into rigid boxes.

Atlas

The inventory runs on continuous dimensions. The Atlas is a browse map of recurring profile patterns in the current model: nearby combinations from the Foundation-plus-Profile architecture, not a rarity chart or a live user distribution.

[Open Atlas →](#)

Why this is not a political compass

The worldview families here are theoretical orientations, not political positions. A person can hold realist instincts on great-power rivalry while holding solidarist instincts on humanitarian law. They can be persuaded by critical political economy on trade and by institutionalism on arms control. Most serious analysts in this field draw on more than one tradition, depending on the issue.

The Foundation is designed to surface which framework dominates your instincts in aggregate, not to assign you a permanent label. The runner-up family often remains nearly as important as the primary one, and some results are better read as overlap than as a sharply sorted type.

Each tradition is an umbrella

None of the families below is a single unified school. Each is a grouping of related arguments that share certain premises — a family resemblance, not a doctrine.

Realism includes classical realists (who ground the argument in human nature and statecraft), structural realists (who locate the explanation in systemic anarchy), offensive realists (who argue the structure pushes toward power maximization), and defensive realists (who argue it often rewards restraint). They share the premise that power and self-help are durable features of world politics — they disagree on what follows from that.

Liberalism is also an umbrella. The tradition modeled here — liberal institutionalism — emphasizes how rules, monitoring, and repeated interaction can make cooperation more durable. Other liberal strands include commercial liberalism (trade and economic interdependence reduce the incentive for conflict), republican liberalism (democratic institutions shape what governments can credibly commit to internationally), and sociological liberalism (transnational actors and networks matter). The Foundation primarily tests institutionalist instincts.

Constructivism ranges from conventional constructivism (norms and identity are empirically important variables) to critical constructivism (which asks whose interests prevailing norms serve) to poststructuralism (which questions the stable identities that even conventional constructivism assumes). What they share is the claim that the meaning of threats and interests is partly socially constructed.

Critical political economy includes Marxist political economy, dependency theory, world-systems theory, neo-Gramscian IPE, and

structural power analysis. They agree that global economic structures shape state autonomy in ways that conventional security analysis misses — they differ on which structural mechanisms matter most and whether reform from within is possible.

Traditions modeled in the Foundation

These four traditions are the ones the Foundation scores directly. Each page explains what the tradition emphasizes, what it misses, and how the rest of the product builds on that baseline rather than replacing it.

STRONGLY MODELED

Realism

World politics is shaped by the distribution of power and the absence of any authority above states.

[Read more →](#)

STRONGLY MODELED

Institutionalism

Cooperation can be made durable through shared rules, monitoring, and repeated interaction — even without a world government.

[Read more →](#)

MODERATELY MODELED

Constructivism

The meaning of threats, alliances, and interests is partly constituted by identity, norms, and shared social expectations.

[Read more →](#)

PARTIALLY MODELED

Critical Political Economy

World politics is shaped by who controls production, finance, and access to markets — not just who has the most tanks.

[Read more →](#)

How the traditions read major issues

Three recurring questions in contemporary foreign policy — seen through all four modeled traditions side by side.

Great-power rivalry

How does each tradition explain the logic of major-power competition — its causes, its dynamics, and what, if anything, can constrain it?

STRATEGIC REALIST

Reads rising-power competition as structurally determined. When a state grows strong enough to challenge the dominant power, conflict risk rises regardless of the challenger's ideology or intentions. The mechanism is not malice but the logic of self-help under anarchy: both sides must assume the worst. Balancing — through alliances, arms investment, and forward positioning — is the expected response.

LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Argues that rivalry can be managed through sustained institutional engagement. Economic interdependence creates domestic stakeholders for stability on both sides. Military transparency and arms-control frameworks reduce the miscalculation risk that turns competition into crisis. The historical record of major-power peace among trading democracies is taken as evidence that structure alone does not determine outcomes.

SOCIAL CONSTRUCTIVIST

Emphasizes that the intensity and character of rivalry are socially constructed — shaped by historical memories, mutual recognition failures, and identity narratives that make adversarial relationships feel inevitable. Points to cases of successful enmity transformation (Franco-German, US-Japanese) as evidence that structure is not destiny. Rival identity constructions can be disrupted through sustained diplomacy, socialization, and domestic political change.

CRITICAL POLITICAL ECONOMIST

Interprets great-power competition partly as a contest over economic governance — currency dominance, technology standards, supply-chain geography, and control of the institutions that set the rules of international trade and investment. Military rivalry is real, but the deeper contest is over whose production and financial structures define the next phase of the world economy.

Trade and technology decoupling

How does each tradition interpret the drive to restrict trade and technology flows in the name of national security — and at what cost?

STRATEGIC REALIST

Treats economic interdependence primarily as a

LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

Warns that broad decoupling is costly to both parties.

SOCIAL CONSTRUCTIVIST

Focuses on the framing: 'decoupling' and 'supply-chain

CRITICAL POLITICAL ECONOMIST

Reads decoupling as a

interdependence primarily as a source of vulnerability when a partner is also an adversary. Technology leadership translates into military advantage, making controls on dual-use exports rational even at economic cost. Relative gains logic applies: a trade arrangement that develops the adversary's industrial base is strategically harmful even if it produces net economic growth.

technology as a competitor, undermines the multilateral trading rules that have underpinned global growth, and is likely to be self-defeating as third parties hedge rather than align. Prefers targeted, narrowly scoped controls embedded in multilateral frameworks — export controls on genuinely dual-use items, investment screening for critical sectors — over wholesale economic separation.

decoupling and supply chain security' are not neutral technical descriptions but constructions that activate adversarial identities and foreclose alternative framings (mutual dependence, shared governance, managed competition). The political narrative shapes the policy as much as the underlying material reality, and the framing can become self-fulfilling.

restructuring of global production hierarchies — a contest over which state's firms control key nodes in the technology supply chain. Asks who bears the adjustment costs (workers, consumers, smaller trading partners) and who benefits (domestic contractors, capital that relocates). Skeptical of framing that treats decoupling as a cost-free national security necessity rather than a political choice with distributional consequences.

Humanitarian intervention

When, if ever, does mass atrocity justify overriding sovereignty — and what explains the pattern of when interventions happen and when they do not?

STRATEGIC REALIST

Deeply skeptical. States invoke humanitarian language to justify actions driven by strategic interests; the correlation between intervention and material stakes is too consistent to ignore. The non-intervention

LIBERAL INSTITUTIONALIST

More permissive when institutional authorization exists. R2P and UN Security Council authorization transform the legitimacy calculus — multilateral intervention with clear objectives and exit criteria is

SOCIAL CONSTRUCTIVIST

The tradition that best explains why the humanitarian intervention norm emerged when it did. Norm entrepreneur networks, the evolution of sovereignty as responsibility, and the diffusion of R2P are prime

CRITICAL POLITICAL ECONOMIST

Skeptical and critical. Examines the material interests behind humanitarian rhetoric: strategic resources, market access, defense industry interests. Notes that intervention patterns correlate

norm protects weaker states

as much as it shields bad actors. Realists prefer restraint except where core interests are directly engaged, and warn that intervention tends to create new instabilities it cannot manage.

preferable to both unilateral

action and inaction. Skeptical of unauthorized intervention on precedent grounds, but supports the institutional framework for managed, collective response to mass atrocity.

constructivist cases. The

tradition also raises critical questions: whose suffering activates the norm, whose does not, and whether the norm has been selectively applied in ways that reflect power rather than principle.

with economic stakes as much as with the severity of crises, and that post-intervention economic arrangements tend to favor the intervening powers and their investors. Humanitarian framing is analyzed as ideology that obscures material motivations.

Important traditions not yet fully modeled

These traditions matter for understanding world politics. They are not yet scored outputs of this version of the inventory — adding them would require new dimensions and items that the current question bank does not support. They are included here because omitting them without explanation would misrepresent the theoretical landscape.

Feminist IR

Feminist IR asks who is made invisible by mainstream IR's focus on states, power, and security. It argues that the discipline's core concepts — security, sovereignty, power — are shaped by assumptions about gender that are rarely examined. Feminist scholars have examined how war affects women differently from men, how militarism is connected to masculine norms, and what a security agenda centered on human vulnerability rather than state survival would look like. The tradition spans liberal feminism (getting more women into existing institutions) and more radical critiques of militarism and the gendered foundations of the state.

Why not yet modeled: Adding feminist IR as a scored family would require new dimensions on human security, gender analysis, and the critique of militarism that the current item bank does not support. Doing it with the current questions would produce spurious classifications.

Postcolonial and Decolonial IR

Postcolonial and decolonial IR scholars argue that the mainstream discipline was built on and for a world organized by European colonial power, and that this origin shapes what questions get asked and which actors get treated as agents rather than objects. They emphasize the colonial legacies that structure contemporary international inequality, the silenced perspectives of the global South, and the need to decolonize both the canon and the practice of IR. They also challenge the universality of Western IR concepts — asking whether 'sovereignty,' 'anarchy,' and 'security' mean the same things to states whose borders were drawn by colonial powers.

Why not yet modeled: Its inclusion would require dimensions on colonial legacies, Eurocentrism, and the politics of knowledge production in IR that would require substantial new question design and validation. The current instrument is likely to misclassify people whose primary orientation is postcolonial — they may land in critical PE or constructivism as the closest available buckets.

Green IR and Ecological Security

Green IR asks what the international system looks like when ecological limits are taken seriously. Climate change, resource scarcity, and biodiversity loss are not just environmental problems — they reshape security calculations, economic structures, and the legitimacy of governance in ways the traditional paradigms were not designed to address. Green IR scholars argue that the state-centric security frame systematically misses the most consequential long-run threats to human welfare, and that a meaningful international order must grapple with planetary boundaries rather than treating nature as a backdrop to great-power politics.

Why not yet modeled: Adding green IR would require new dimensions on ecological security, the relationship between development and environmental constraint, and the governance of global commons. These are distinct theoretical commitments that cannot be captured by the current seven dimensions without stretching their meaning.

English School / International Society

The English School occupies a middle ground between realism and liberalism. It argues that states form something like an international society — a community with shared norms, rules, and institutions that constrain behavior, even in the absence of world government. It is distinctive for taking international law and diplomacy seriously as social practices rather than mere instruments of power. The pluralism-solidarism debate within the English School — whether international society is primarily organized around state sovereignty or broader humanitarian norms — maps onto this Foundation's order-justice dimension, making it the tradition most partially captured by the current instrument.

Why not yet modeled: The English School's full theoretical depth — its account of international society, the role of diplomacy as a social institution, and the historical sociology of international order — is not yet modeled. The order-justice dimension captures one important debate within the tradition, but the broader framework deserves dedicated dimensions and item coverage.

A note on coverage and the Western canon

The traditions described here — and the Foundation that draws on them — reflect IR theory as it has been predominantly taught and published in Anglo-American and Western European universities. This is a real limitation. IR as a discipline has been shaped by the strategic concerns, historical experiences, and institutional positions of a particular set of actors. Scholars from non-Western contexts often read the same international situations through different priors, shaped by colonial legacies, geographic position, and strategic cultures that the mainstream theoretical canon was not designed to capture.

This inventory measures theoretical orientation as expressed through questions drawn from that canon. It does not adjust scores for national background, and it does not claim to capture how people from all strategic cultures approach world politics. The postcolonial and decolonial traditions in the gap section above are partly a response to this problem.

Take the Foundation →